star, but I want more protection than that. I think there should be a law of Nature to prevent a star from behaving in this absurd way!”

Then Eddington argued that Chandrasekhar’s mathematical proof of his result could not be trusted because it was based on an inadequately sophisticated meshing of special relativity with quantum mechanics. “I do not regard the offspring of such a union as born in lawful wedlock,” Eddington said. “1 feel satisfied myself that [if the meshing is made correctly], the relativity corrections are compensated, so that we come back to the ‘ordinary’ formula” (that is, to a ⅘ resistance, which would permit white dwarfs to be arbitrarily massive and thereby would enable pressure to halt the contraction of Sirius at the hypothetical dotted curve in Figure 4.4). Eddington then sketched how *he* thought special relativity and quantum mechanics should be meshed, a rather different kind of mesh than Chandrasekhar, Stoner, and Anderson had used, and a mesh, Eddington claimed, that would save all stars from the black-hole fate.

Chandrasekhar was shocked. He had never expected such an attack on his work. Why had Eddington not discussed it with him in advance? And as for Eddington’s argument, to Chandrasekhar it looked specious—almost certainly wrong.

Now, Arthur Eddington was *the* great man of British astronomy. His discoveries were almost legendary. He was largely responsible for as tronomers’ understanding of normal stars like the Sun and Sirius, their interiors, their atmospheres, and the light that they emit; so, naturally, the fellows of the Society, and astronomers throughout. the world, listened with great respect. Clearly, if Eddington thought Chandrasekhar’s analysis incorrect, then it must be incorrect.